

AGA DOMAŃSKA

PRODUCT DESIGNER

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SUMMARY

Product Designer with 7 years' experience turning complex, data-rich products and specialist workflows into clear, accessible user experiences. I work end to end - from discovery, research and requirements definition through interaction design, prototyping and frontend implementation - and bring strong technical fluency to collaboration with subject experts and engineering teams.

EXPERIENCE

Cottage Labs, Product Designer & Frontend Developer

(2019 – Present, fully remote)

Directory of Open Access Journals (DOAJ)

- Lead end-to-end product and UX design across research, publishing and academic platforms as the only designer in a 12-person remote team, working directly with clients, subject experts and engineers from discovery and requirements definition through delivery.
- Serve as sole Product Designer and one of two frontend developers for DOAJ, a widely used open-access journal platform. Facilitate workshops, map complex editorial processes and translate specialist working practices into clear, accessible digital workflows.
- Designed DOAJ's new Editorial Workflow and Triage experience, including guided compliance checks, application history, decision-support patterns, accessibility behaviour and reusable interaction patterns for later review stages.
- Design and implement ongoing DOAJ product improvements, including passwordless authentication and collaborative flags, combining UX/UI design with frontend implementation to ensure solutions remain practical through delivery.

The Metadata Exchange Platform (MEx), Robert Koch Institute

- Led the design and ongoing product management of MEx, Robert Koch Institute's multilingual research database, from early discovery and information architecture through usability evaluation, delivery and continuous improvement.
- Designed MEx search and record experiences for dense, complex metadata, including decisions around dataset and variable search, search continuity, progressive disclosure and the presentation of missing or unavailable metadata.
- Coordinated a cross-functional team of four on MEx, working across design, engineering and client stakeholders while also contributing directly to frontend implementation and developer handover.

Other projects

- Redesigned complex, data-heavy interfaces for projects including **EMLO**, increasing usable content area by 27% and visible rows per view from 1 – 2 to 8 – 10 while maintaining readability, stability and accessibility.
- Carried out accessibility-focused design and evaluation work across repository and publishing products, covering semantic structure, keyboard and focus behaviour, cognitive accessibility and implementation guidance.
- Designed and customised InvenioRDM-based repository interfaces for organisations including the **University of Chicago** and **Imperial College London**, combining UX/UI design, accessibility evaluation and frontend delivery.
- Led **Cottage Labs**' brand and website redesign, creating a new visual identity, design system, case-study structure and website used for client communication and events.

SPEAKING

"Beyond FAIR: Designing Cognitive Accessibility in Data-Rich Repositories"

Open Repositories 2026 — Online, June 8–11, 2026

SKILLS

Product design & research: Product design, UX research, user interviews, usability testing, interaction design, information architecture, user journeys, wireframing and prototyping, requirements definition

Accessibility: WCAG 2.2, cognitive accessibility, inclusive design, semantic HTML, keyboard and focus behaviour

Collaboration: Workshop facilitation, client discovery, stakeholder engagement, cross-functional collaboration with product managers, subject experts and engineers

Tools & development: Figma, HTML, CSS/SCSS, JavaScript, Python, Git/GitHub, design systems and component libraries

EDUCATION

MSc Astrophysics, Distinction

Liverpool John Moores University, UK

MSc Automation and Robotics, Good+

Gdańsk University of Technology, Poland